CHAPTER 22

Closing Remarks



This chapter is part of the PINK reading tour. See Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3, for alternative reading tours.

So this is it. This marks the end of my attempt to translate the *world's leading architecture framework* into a *practical approach*. One that sheds new light on applying the TOGAF Standard in a more accessible way.

I strongly believe that the TOGAF Standard is still highly relevant today. It covers all the necessary aspects for creating a sound Enterprise Architecture. The framework is supplemented with various methods and techniques that provide the right tools for an effective approach. Yet, many practitioners do not apply it as intended. I believe this is because they do not fully know *how* to apply it. This is partly due to the amount of information in the framework and how that information is explained. Sometimes, it may seem vague or even slightly academic. This causes many architects to abandon the framework, leaving room for myths to emerge.

Many of the myths that surround the framework stem from a lack of understanding of how the framework's theory is applied. This leads to further misunderstandings in practice.

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The seven most common myths are listed below:

- The TOGAF Standard is only for large organizations.
- The TOGAF Standard is a rigid, prescriptive framework.
- The TOGAF Standard is only about IT Architecture.
- The TOGAF Standard replaces other frameworks.
- The TOGAF Standard is outdated and no longer relevant.
- The TOGAF Standard is just about documentation.
- The Architecture Development Method must be followed step by step.

As I bring this book to a close, I feel compelled to dispel these myths.

The TOGAF Standard Is Only for Large Organizations: In practice, the TOGAF Standard is used fairly regularly in large organizations and less frequently in smaller ones. However, it is a misconception that the TOGAF Standard is only applicable to large organizations. In fact, the use of any framework is independent of an organization's size. Every organization benefits from using an architectural framework.

Granted, not every organization will use a framework to the same extent because there is not always a need to do so. Architecture frameworks – and the TOGAF Standard is no different – are scalable and adaptable to any situation or organization size. They provide insight, overview, and guidance for a structured approach to work, which is beneficial to any organization, large or small. Every organization should want its goals translated into the impact they will have on operations. A framework such as the TOGAF Standard can be tremendously helpful in this regard.

The TOGAF Standard Is a Rigid, Prescriptive Framework: Contrary to popular belief, the TOGAF Standard is a highly flexible framework. Rather than following a strict set of rules, organizations are free to tailor it to their specific needs. Chapter 17 is entirely devoted to tailoring the framework.

The TOGAF Standard is very complete in that it contains a lot of information on how to approach different situations and scenarios. This wealth of information is sometimes seen as something that must be followed exactly. However, this is not the case.

The essential scaffolding of the TOGAF Framework is the concepts. Everything else in the TOGAF Framework is either an example or a starter set to get you moving. If you do not like the example, then you can take advantage of the modular structure of the TOGAF Framework and substitute it [18].

The framework simply describes every component, entity, or concept encountered in an architecture practice. This does not mean that architecture must adhere to everything written in the TOGAF Standard. The framework acts as a blueprint that needs to be customized. Then, it can be applied as best suits the organization.

The TOGAF Standard Is Only About IT Architecture: Given the scope of Enterprise Architecture, it's clear that IT Architecture (also referred to as Technology Architecture in the TOGAF Standard) is part of the bigger picture. However, Technology Architecture is only *one of the four core domains* of Enterprise Architecture. The other three are Business Architecture, Data Architecture, and Application Architecture (see Figure 22-1).

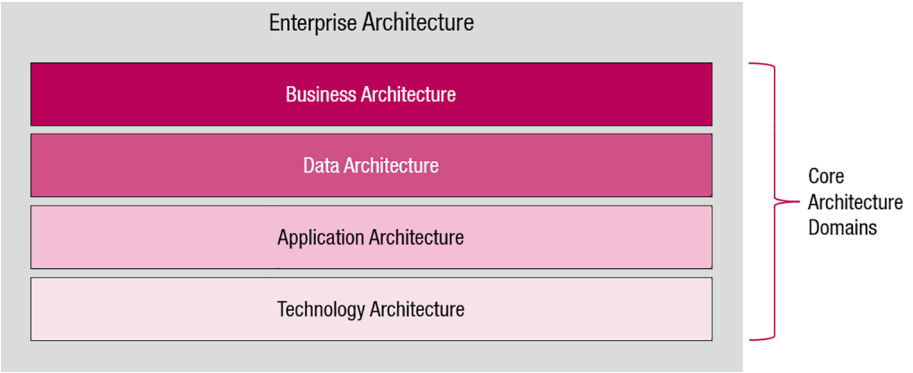


Figure 22-1. *Four core architecture domains*

The TOGAF Standard is an Enterprise Architecture framework because it covers *all four domains*. It provides a holistic view of an organization.

The framework references the BIZBOK Guide, among others, for its Business Architecture concepts and techniques. This is because the BIZBOK Guide describes the content of this particular architecture domain in much more detail than the TOGAF Standard does. Rather than duplicating the information, The Open Group decided to refer to this other source.

The TOGAF Standard Replaces Other Frameworks: The TOGAF Standard *is not in competition* with other frameworks, such as Zachman, SAFe, ITIL, or COBIT. In fact, it is sometimes beneficial not to source all the architecture-related information from a single framework. The TOGAF Standard acknowledges this.

> Because the TOGAF Standard is a generic framework and intended to be used in a wide variety of environments […], it may be used either in its own right, with the generic deliverables that it describes, or else these deliverables may be replaced or extended by a more specific set, defined in any other framework that the architect considers relevant [2].

The TOGAF Standard provides generic deliverables and suggests a generic approach to architectural practice. However, if there are components from other frameworks that better suit the organization, they should certainly be used.

The TOGAF Standard Is Outdated and No Longer Relevant: The TOGAF Standard is neither outdated nor irrelevant. Over its many years of existence, the framework has continued to evolve. It now reflects modern architectural trends, such as digital transformation, cloud computing, and agile methodologies.

A new and updated edition of the TOGAF Standard is released every few years. Each new edition addresses the shortcomings of previous versions and adds new content, trends, or techniques. The Core Content remains largely the same because it doesn't change much over the years.

The TOGAF Standard Is Just About Documentation: Many practitioners still believe that architectural work requires producing extensive documentation. This seems to be based on the idea that the TOGAF Standard deliberately captures everything related to the profession and its work. However, this assumption is unwarranted because it is not stated anywhere in the framework.

Of course, the TOGAF Standard recognizes the need to document important matters, such as agreements made at the beginning of architectural work. There are four architecture documents that need to be created. Each document has a set structure that must be reflected in the final product. However, this does not mean that every aspect of architectural work must be endlessly documented.

One source of confusion may be that architects think every diagram, matrix, or catalog must be included in the Architecture Repository, which is another misconception. The Architecture Repository should contain Architecture and Solution Building Blocks, not elaborate solution diagrams, matrices, or catalogs.

The TOGAF Standard certainly does not suggest endless documentation. This is one of the myths that arise from a lack of understanding of the framework.

The Architecture Development Method Must Be Followed Step by Step: The Architecture Development Method graphic is still frequently misinterpreted as a linear, waterfall-style process. In reality, however, it is a *logical method* that *groups key activities* to clarify their relationships and information flow. The well-known graphic is a stylized representation showing these information flows. It is *not a representation of an activity sequence*.

The Architecture Development Method should not be understood as a process model [18].

Like the full framework, the Architecture Development Method allows for the same amount of tailoring and supports four different types of iteration, making it suitable for any situation. It is *not limited* to being followed step by step.

These myths exist because the TOGAF Standard is often misinterpreted. This is usually caused by *not carefully reading* the framework's content. Another reason is that practitioners continue to use *outdated information*. Often, they rely on what they learned years ago when they first took their TOGAF exam. Other times, they simply accept information they've heard somewhere else as truth without giving it any further thought.

In this book, I have addressed and refuted the aforementioned myths and arguments against using the TOGAF Standard. To this end, I have provided numerous examples of the TOGAF Standard's practical application. These examples are easy to understand and are drawn from daily practice. They demonstrate the framework's added value.

I have presented a practical approach that clarifies the methodology and encourages more practitioners to use and tailor the framework. After all, this is precisely how the TOGAF Standard is intended to be used.

The idea is to apply the *relevant parts* to your situation or organization in a way that solves architectural challenges.

This book covers the most important parts of the framework and includes additional topics that I felt were necessary to provide a comprehensive overview of how to use the framework. I included additional aspects that needed more context and explanation. The primary purpose of this book, however, is to help you master the most important parts of the world's leading architecture framework.

In the introduction of the book, I mentioned my primary reasons for writing it:

- To **explain and clarify** the methodology of the TOGAF Standard
- To present a **practical approach** to using the framework
- To show you how to **correctly apply and tailor** the framework
- And, by doing so, to **refute the unfounded criticism**

Throughout the various chapters of the book, I have explained and clarified the most fundamental concepts of the framework in detail. I provided actionable steps for approaching various scenarios and situations and explained how to implement these concepts. I also demonstrated how to tailor the framework by showing how to adjust the Enterprise Metamodel and the Content Framework and how to apply a tailored Architecture Development Method.

I have demonstrated how the TOGAF Standard can be utilized to implement Enterprise Architecture, using compelling examples.

I hope to have enabled you to use the world's leading architecture framework as it was intended: in a *practical* and *pragmatic* way that can be *tailored to the situation*.

Your feedback is invaluable. Leaving a review on websites like Amazon not only supports the work but also helps future readers decide if this book is right for them.